Gmail

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On staying awake to what matters

1 message

Beyond The Bend Yoga <laura@beyondthebendyoga.ca> Sun, Dec 28, 2025 at 10:00 AM
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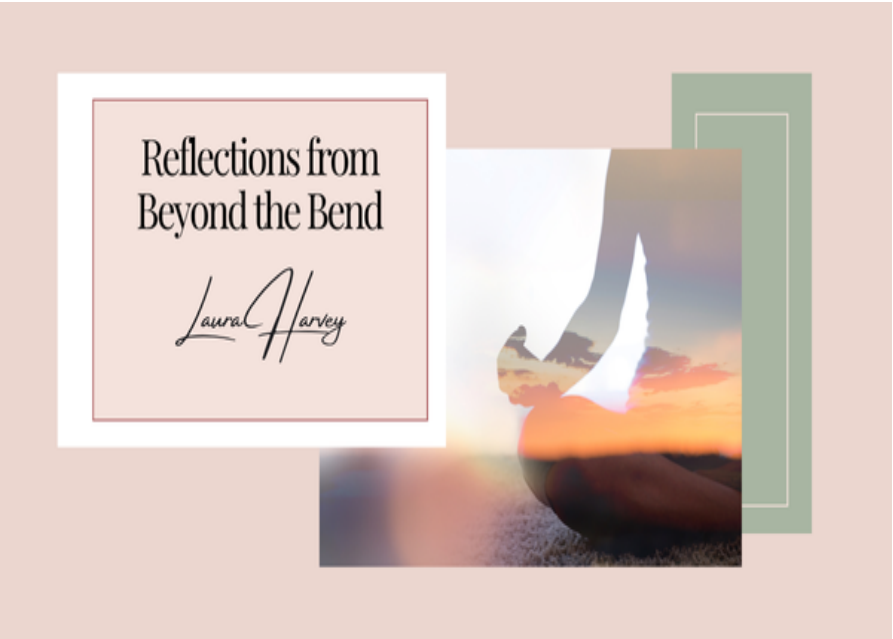
BEYOND THE BEND YOGA



Hello Laura

I've been sitting with something for a while now, and I'm not entirely sure how to say it, but it feels important to share.

As I've been building Beyond the Bend Yoga, I keep noticing this tension. I'm trying to create space for genuine stillness and self-connection, while also doing all the things that let this work exist in the world. You know, the websites and schedules and all of that. It's not that any of it is wrong. It's just that I'm learning to hold both at once, and sometimes it feels like walking a tightrope.

I guess what I'm really thinking about is what we choose to protect when something deeply personal meets the marketplace. And I wanted to invite you into that conversation with me.

With warmth and gratitude,

Laura ❤️

This Week's Wellness Wisdom

Stillness, Commerce, and What We Choose to Protect

By Laura Harvey | Beyond the Bend Yoga

As I've been developing Beyond the Bend Yoga, I've been grappling with something I want to share honestly with you.

I care deeply about offering something that genuinely supports people. Something that helps them feel steadier in themselves, less rushed, more at home in their own bodies. And at the same time, I'm building a business. There are websites and schedules and pricing and systems. None of that is inherently wrong. It's just the landscape we're working in.

But here's the thing. Yoga didn't begin there. It didn't start as an industry or a strategy or something to package and promote. It began as a personal relationship with breath, sensation, and awareness. And I notice how easily the center of gravity can shift. When a practice rooted in listening becomes something we consume, our attention often moves outward. Am I doing this right? Is this what it's supposed to look like? Am I keeping up? Without meaning to, yoga can become another place where we strive, compare, or shape ourselves rather than soften into

what's actually happening.

I've felt this tension in my own body. The pull to keep up. To offer more. To make things look a certain way. To fit into the language of productivity and progress. It's not really a conflict so much as a constant balancing act, a remembering again and again of why I'm here in the first place.

Yoga was never meant to make us more efficient or impressive. It was meant to help us become more present. To notice. To feel. To respond rather than react.

And look, money isn't the issue. Teachers deserve to be paid. Spaces need to be supported. Many people are offering their work with real care and integrity. At the same time, it's worth noticing how easily depth can get overshadowed when there's pressure to produce or perform. Subtlety doesn't always translate well online. Stillness doesn't announce itself.

What feels most important to me is paying attention to how commercialization can subtly undermine inner authority. When students are taught, even unintentionally, to look outside themselves for validation, correction, or approval, they can lose trust in their own experience. A practice meant to cultivate agency can, without care, do the opposite.

I don't have tidy answers to any of this. What I do have is an ongoing awareness of the tension I'm holding as I develop this business. I want to offer something that truly supports people in slowing down, listening inward, and reconnecting with a sense of stillness that already exists inside them. And I'm doing that within systems that can easily pull us in the opposite direction.

I see how quickly yoga can lose its center when it becomes something to sell, scale, or perfect. How easily it can turn into another place where we perform, strive, or look outside ourselves for cues about what's right. That loss of connection to the deeper purpose of the practice is exactly what I'm trying to stay awake to, both for myself and for the people who practice with me.

So this work, for me, is a continual act of remembering. Remembering why I began. Remembering what yoga has offered me when it's been at its most honest. And remembering that stillness isn't something I can package or promise. It's something I can protect space for.

That commitment shapes how I teach, how I structure what I offer, and how I move through the business side of things. Not perfectly. Not without friction. But with care.

Because the last thing I want is for yoga to become another place where

we lose ourselves. My hope is that it remains a place where we come back.

Speaking of That Balance...

Okay, so I just wrote all of that, and now I'm going to tell you about the classes I would love to fill. The irony isn't lost on me.

My winter session starts January 12th. I'm teaching four weekly classes: some flowing, some restorative, all grounded in the same approach to slowing down and listening inward. You can join in person here in Sherwood Park or practice with me online.

Here's what I'm noticing: lately, the people joining me have been coming through personal recommendations. Someone saying "I think you'd connect with this" or "This might be what you're looking for." And that means everything to me. It tells me we're building something real here, not just filling spots.

So if this work resonates with you and you've been thinking about joining, I'd love to have you. And if someone comes to mind who might benefit from this kind of space? Please pass it along. Word of mouth is how we find each other.

If you're curious,

https://beyondthebendyoga.ca/classes

And if you know someone who might need this kind of space right now? Please pass it along. Word of mouth is how we find each other.

OUR WEEKLY PRACTICE:

Self-Inquiry

This week, I'm inviting you to sit with a few questions. Not to answer them perfectly or figure anything out. Just to notice what comes up when you ask.

Find a quiet moment. Maybe with your journal, maybe just with yourself. And gently ask:

Where am I performing instead of being present?

What happens in my body when I look outside myself for permission or validation?

What am I protecting space for in my life right now?

Where do I already know what's true, even if I haven't acted on it yet?

You don't need to answer all of them. You don't need to answer any of them completely. Just let them sit with you. Notice what surfaces. Notice what your body knows before your mind tries to organize it into something neat.

That's the practice. Just noticing. Just listening.

A Closing Thought

I'm not sharing this to make you second-guess your practice or the teachers you trust. I just think honesty matters. I want you to know what I'm paying attention to as I build this space. And honestly, I think we're all navigating this in our own ways, this tension between what's true for us and what the world seems to ask of us.

If this lands with you at all, I'd really love to hear about it. Where have you felt that pull between going deeper and keeping up appearances? Between trusting yourself and looking outside for answers?

I'm genuinely asking. This conversation feels important to me, even when it's a little uncomfortable.

With warmth and gratitude,
Laura 💗

What are your thoughts on this tension between stillness and commerce? Hit reply. I read every response.

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